

Leadership Skills in Teachers

Great Teachers are Great Leaders



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Schools are dynamic systems that demand change and accountability simultaneously and at a breakneck speed. Schools need an empowered workforce with leaders at every level. Allowing teacher expertise to be acknowledged and become a component of the resources offered to all is an emerging skill for building leaders and for building leadership capacity at a time when it is desperately needed.

Teachers have various levels of school leadership qualities. Some are learned and some are part of their personality. Great teachers possess a combination of leadership qualities that are respected by the students, parents, peers and the community. They can accomplish important tasks because of this connection they have with their profession and the people they touch through it.

Essential Leadership Qualities to become a Great Teacher

1.Possess the respect of colleagues and supervisors
2.Understand the culture of the school
3.Are trustworthy
4.Are open to the views and ideas of all, non-judgmentally
5.Are non-threatening
6.Respond positively and actively to colleagues seeking feedback, new ideas, and methods

School Leadership Qualities Every Teacher must Possess

(i) Commitment to the students and educators:
Teachers are dedicated to providing each student the best possible environment and tools for learning.

They work with the parents to understand what challenges the students may have to learning and what approaches might work best with them individually. They engage their coworkers for input on how to structure their lesson plans and teaching style to be the best educator.

(ii) Passionate about teaching and learning
As a leader, teachers are always practicing their art and learning how to improve their techniques. One student's question can drive an entire lesson plan from which all students will benefit.

(iii) Collaboration with others
Teachers know that the best way to be successful is to work with others to create a quality teaching environment. They will look for those with similar passions and solicit support from people at all levels within the school system. They maintain the respect from others for their high quality of teaching standards, and they give recognition to others for their approaches.

(iv) Communication and rapport
Great teachers are great communicators. They know the best ways to interact with students, parents, faculty and coworkers. They are skilled at listening and respect the opinions and ideas of others. They look for different ways to communicate knowing that people are receptive to various techniques:

(v) Embracing change
Throughout every teacher's career a number of changes will occur. A great teacher knows this and anticipates change. They are courageous about trying new things and aren't hesitant to make adjustments until they are as effective as they can be. Change gives teachers the opportunity to perform their roles even better. So rather than waiting until they are directed, they seek out ways to improve.

Conclusion

A hallmark of leadership, therefore, is the ability to collaborate with others. They must be respected for their own instructional skills. They also must understand evidence and information and recognize the need to focus on those aspects of the school's program that will yield important gains in student learning. They display optimism and enthusiasm, confidence and decisiveness. Many attributes of good teacher leaders are persuasiveness, open-mindedness, flexibility, confidence, and expertise in their fields.

To assume a leadership role, they may need expertise in curriculum planning, assessment design, data analysis, and the like. They may also need to develop the abilities to listen actively, facilitate meetings, keep a group discussion on track, decide on a course of action, and monitor progress.



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